I outlined the authentication process for traditional web apps in chapter 23. When a user signs in to your application, you set an encrypted cookie. This cookie contains a serialized version of the `ClaimsPrincipal` of the user, including their ID and any associated claims. When you make a second request, the browser automatically sends this cookie. The `AuthenticationMiddleware` then decodes the cookie, deserializes the `ClaimsPrincipal`, and sets the current user for the request, as shown previously in figure 23.3 and reproduced in figure 25.1.